NICHOLAS GRIFFO

Filmmaker & Creative Technologist | Generative AI Red Teaming
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SUMMARY

Filmmaker and creative technologist who finds where generative AI breaks on real production work. 600+ hours since May 2026 red teaming and evaluating frontier image, video, and agent systems for three AI companies. Seven years before that running art departments on features and on campaigns for Google, Meta, and Riot Games, where a tool holds up on the day or it does not.

AI EXPERIENCE

AI Red Teaming Contractor | Handshake AI | Remote | Oct 2026 - Present

- Stress test an AI agent operating generative video tools, mapping the production tasks it cannot complete and documenting each failure.

AI Model Evaluation Contractor | Micro1 | Remote | Jul 2026 - Present

- Assess frontier model performance on film and entertainment use cases for a leading AI lab.
- Stress test generative systems over multi-day engagements; document where and why they fail.

Creative Technologist | Mercor Intelligence | Remote | May 2026 - Present

- Independent contractor providing creative and visual expertise to help improve generative AI models for a leading AI lab.
- Apply art direction standards to image, 3D, and design outputs, judging quality, realism, and creative usability.

PRODUCTION EXPERIENCE

Production Designer & Art Director | Freelance | Los Angeles, CA and New York, NY | 2019 - Present

Sinking Cities, Independent 16mm Feature (2024-2025)

- Production designer. Led all set design and fabrication across 6+ sets. Shooting on film locks every decision at capture.

Camp Pleasant Lake (2024) and Porterville (2023), Independent Features

- Art Director. Led the art department crew, budget, set design, sourcing, and props.

Indulgence, Falling Dominoes (2023)

- Production designer on an independent feature. Partnered with the writer-directors from pre-production to build the visual identity, then owned sourcing, scheduling, set construction, and continuity.

Google, "Real Tone" Campaign (2023)

- Production Buyer and Set Designer. Bought for the art department and led cost and timeline assessment across cross-functional teams.

Meta, "Wave" Campaign (2023)

- Set Designer. Produced design reports and proposals, and adapted builds through client and creative review cycles.

We Are Social / Riot Games, "Wild Rift" (2022)

- Set Decorator on a web commercial and experiential build. Constructed a gallery of framed fan art that carried over into a live experiential space after wrap.

Good Boy, Television Pilot / Jubilee Media (2021)

- Art Director. Set and executed the visual direction against a limited budget.

Zero Avenue, Independent Feature / The Frei Group (2019-2021)

- Property Master. Led an in-house team of up to 10 building fictional signage and magazine properties, avoiding outsourcing and schedule slip.

EARLY CAREER

Assistant Production Designer, commercials for Aperol, Red Bull Music, Scotts Ortho, and Lay's (2019-2021). Set Dresser on features "You Should Have Left" (Blumhouse / Universal, dir. David Koepp) and "A Mouthful of Air" (Maven Pictures).

Grip on Netflix series "Dressing Funny" (Sawhorse); Art PA and On-Set Dresser on Netflix series "Two Sentence Horror Stories" (Stage 13); Grip and Swing on BET feature "Sisters"; camera crew on "6 Tales of Sin"; Assistant Camera on TLC series "90 Day Fiance" (2019-2022).

Web/UX Designer, Shulian Nell (2021-2023). Equipment Technician, Pier 59 Studios (2017-2018). Journalist, Puss Puss Magazine (2018-2019).

SKILLS

Generative AI: red teaming, agentic tool-use testing, model evaluation, failure-mode analysis, visual realism assessment.

AI Tools: Runway, Midjourney, Claude, ChatGPT, Grok, Cursor.

Production: production design, set fabrication, art direction, budget management, sourcing, multi-location coordination, cross-department scheduling and handoffs, vendor management.

Software: Photoshop (7+ yrs), Premiere Pro, Illustrator, InDesign, DaVinci Resolve, Figma, Notion, Shopify, HTML/CSS (basic).

PROJECTS & EDUCATION

Writer. Two original feature screenplays and multiple shorts. Currently developing a proof-of-concept short.

American Movies, independent production company. Ultralight Base, founder: gear and permit database for 60+ trails, kept current by AI agents.

BA, International & Global Studies, Minor in History. University of North Carolina at Greensboro. Eagle Scout, Boy Scouts of America.